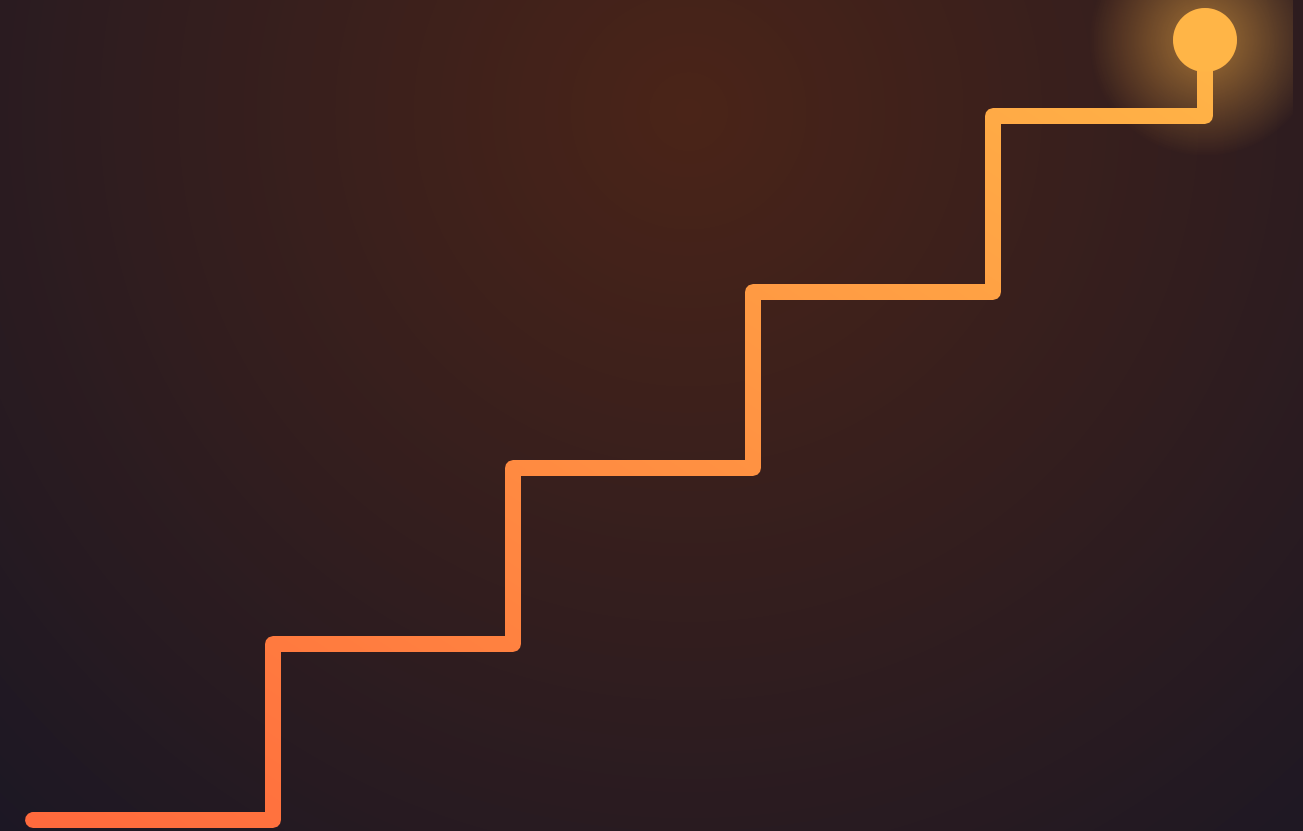


PASO · SPANISH FOR "STEP"

PASO

Every step counts.

School plans for newcomer students.



THE PROBLEM

MEET ANA.

16

years old

GUATEMALA

just arrived

9TH GRADE

already finished

In Massachusetts, she's put back in ninth grade, because no one can tell what her transcript counts for.

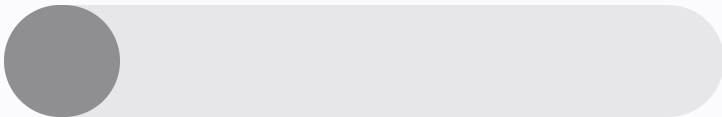
Where she enrolls decides where she starts.

Springfield



64%

Boston



16%

Older newcomers (ages 16–18) placed in 9th grade.

38

point gap, even after comparing similar students.

Ana is a composite. Source: Mantil et al. (2026), Land of Opportunity? Annenberg Institute at Brown University.

WHY IT MATTERS

ANA IS NOT ALONE.

1,070,113

immigrant students in U.S. schools who arrived within the last three school years (2021–22).



1 in 2

Massachusetts high-school newcomers arrive at 16 or older

54%

of newcomers graduate from high school (pre-pandemic)

1 in 6

students entering urban Massachusetts high schools is a newcomer

WHAT WE HEARD

Staff wait because no recommendation comes with *proof*.

5+ hours

across three weeks, on one Arabic transcript for a 10th-grade Syrian student.

Generic tools

Staff rely on informal Google searches or unstandardized translation tools.

Letters from scratch

Every case gets a custom letter for the district and the family.

Fear of a wrong grade

Staff delay recommendations while they wait for the district to respond.

What if every recommendation came with its proof, in days?

Source: our Mom Test interview with a youth education specialist at a refugee resettlement affiliate.

INTRODUCING

PASO

A transcript photo in. A signed school plan out,
in days, not weeks.



HOW IT WORKS

01

Snap the transcript

The case manager photographs each page. Paso finds the edges. Any language, any format.

Photo

Read

Check

Review

Plan

Demo · sample data · Target: 3 business days, end to end

CAPTURE

Scan records

Page 1 of 3 · hold steady



WHAT PASO HANDS THE SCHOOL

Generated for Ana · sample data

PASO

Starting-point report

Report P-0001 · Sample

Student	Age	Prior schooling	Language	Records
Ana (composite)	16	Guatemala · grade 9 done	Spanish	3 transcript photos

Recommended placement

GRADE 10

Credits recognized

4.5

Next math course

GEOMETRY

SKILLS CHECK

Math: 10 of 12 correct

Taken in Spanish

REVIEWER

✓ Signed

Trained bilingual reviewer

FAMILY COPY · ESPAÑOL

Empieza en 10.º grado, con 4.5 créditos reconocidos. Lleve este plan a la inscripción.

Prior course (Guatemala)	Matches	Credit	Proof
Matemática III	Algebra 1	1.0	Transcript + skills check
Ciencias Naturales	Physical Science	1.0	Transcript
Idioma Español	Spanish	2.0	Credit by exam
Estudios Sociales	World History	0.5	Transcript, partial

UNDER THE HOOD

HOW PASO KNOWS WHAT ANA KNOWS.

Adaptive skills check

Two right in a row: harder. A miss: easier. It stops when the level is clear.



Every question is tagged to a standard. $2x + 5 = 17 \rightarrow$ A-REI.B.3, solve linear equations in one variable.

Algebra 1 confirmed, 10 of 12. Next course: Geometry.

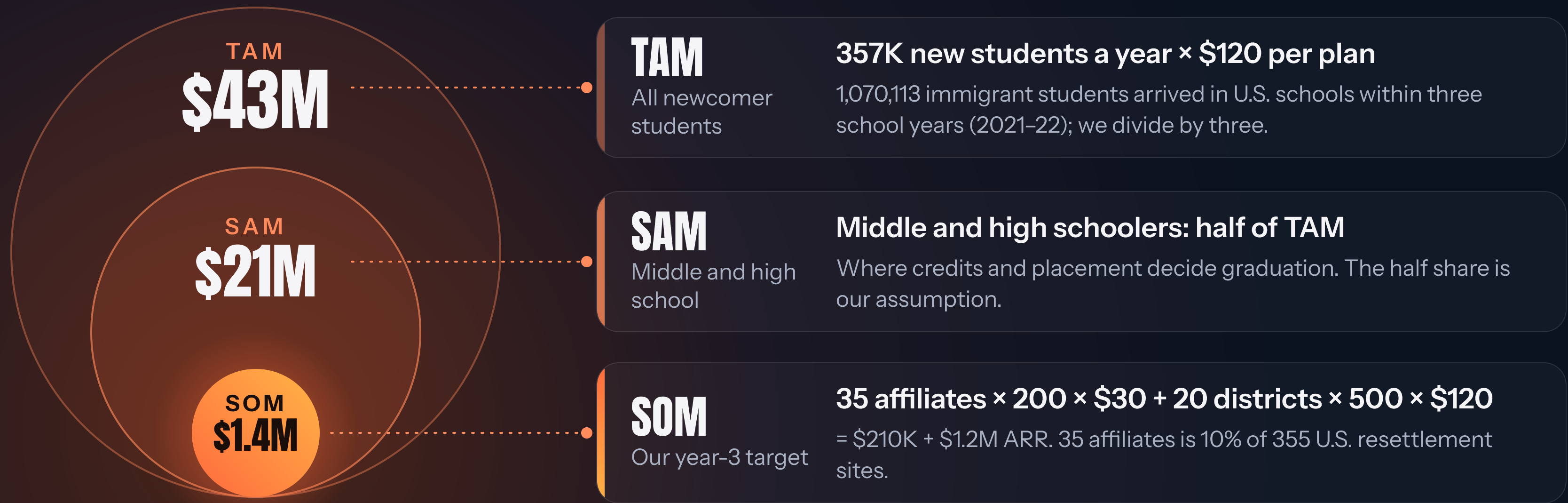
THE DATA LAYER

- 1 Records**
Photos become structured courses, grades and years. No field for immigration status.
- 2 Standards map**
Each home-country course maps to state standards, then to the district's courses and credit rules.
- 3 Evidence**
Skills-check results by standard, plus every reviewer decision and its reason.
- 4 Outcomes**
Which plans districts accept, and the credits students keep.

Every signed plan improves the map. That's the moat.

MARKET

A \$43M-A-YEAR U.S. MARKET TO START.



Risk: refugee admissions 100,034 (FY24) → 10,258 (FY26, 10 mo.). Districts are our second market.

Paso estimates. Inputs, sources and assumptions are in the appendix.

BUSINESS MODEL

NONPROFITS PAY. FAMILIES NEVER DO.

AFFILIATES PAY · NOW

\$30

per student, from existing case-management budgets. 200 students = \$6,000 a year.

DISTRICTS PAY · NEXT

\$120

per plan, below WES (from \$186) and ECE (\$199) course-by-course reports.

A PLAN COSTS US

≈ \$11

Reviewer time, 20 min at \$30/h (≈ \$10), plus AI (≈ \$1). Falls as the map grows.



Gross margin per plan. Prices and costs are model assumptions we are testing, not results. WES and ECE prices from their own websites.

HOW IT SCALES

START HERE. THEN EVERYWHERE NEWCOMERS ARRIVE.

What compounds at every step: the course map, the question bank and district acceptance data. Each new place costs less than the last.

NOW MASSACHUSETTS

Spanish and Arabic transcripts. Resettlement affiliates pay \$30 per student.

NEXT MORE U.S. STATES

Many states share Common Core math, so most of the map carries over. Districts pay \$120.

THEN HOME COUNTRIES

Each new home country is mapped once, then reused for every student from it.

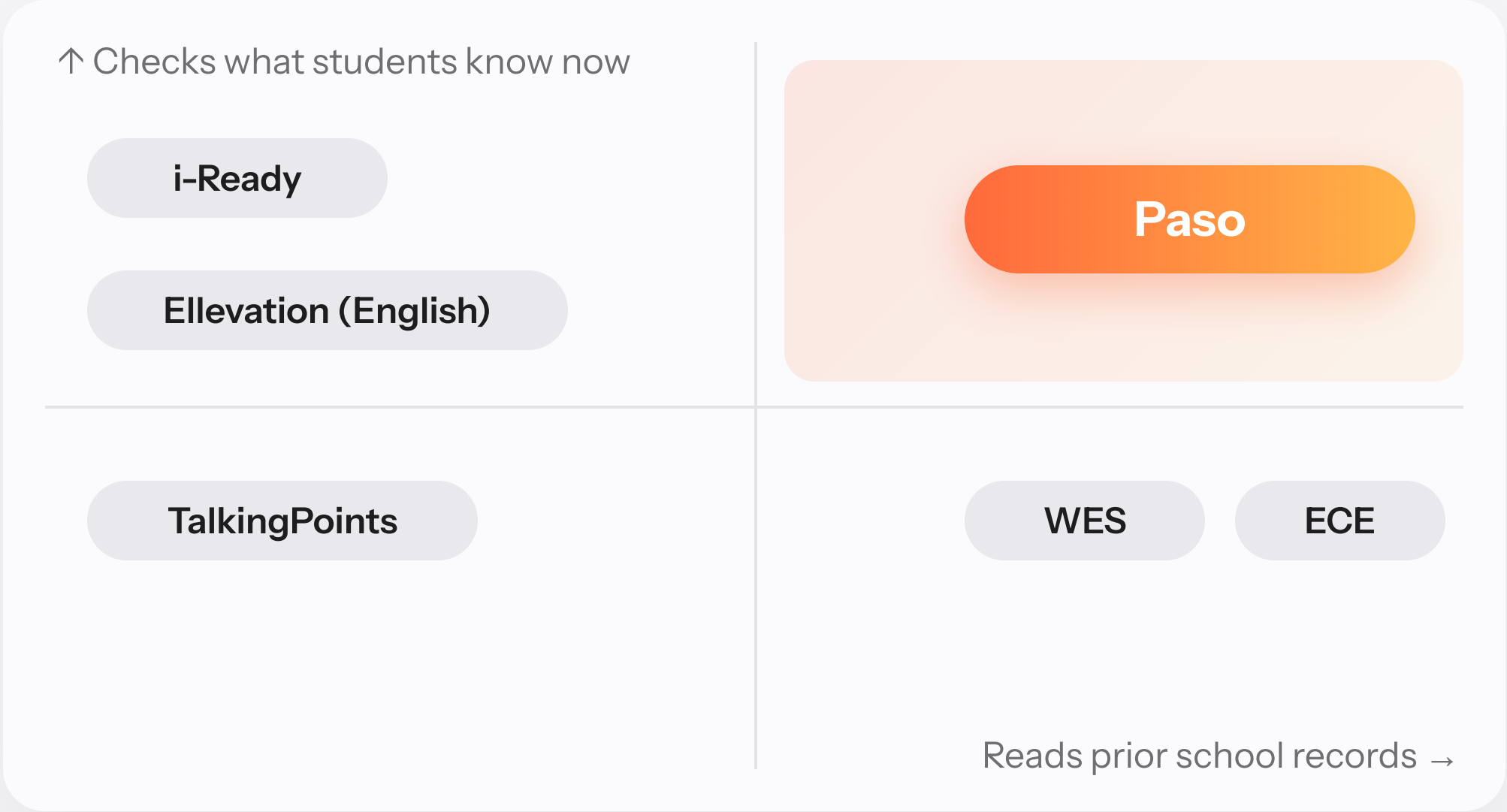
LATER HOST COUNTRIES

Countries that receive newcomers. 45M children are forcibly displaced worldwide.

Expansion steps are plans, not commitments. 45M: UNHCR, end of 2025; a measure of need, not a market size.

COMPETITION

EVERYONE ELSE DOES HALF THE JOB.



WHY WE WIN

A course map that grows

Every reviewed match, like year-3 math from Guatemala to Algebra 1, is saved and reused.

Proof schools accept

We track how often districts accept our plans. No competitor reports that number.

A buyer no one serves

Resettlement nonprofits pay; families never do. Others sell to individuals or districts.

Source: our competitive scan of each company's own website, October 2026.

HOW WE PROVE IT

TEN FAMILIES FIRST, BY HAND.

MVP 1: ten families with one resettlement partner, run with WhatsApp, Claude checked by a bilingual reviewer, Google Sheets, a paper skills check and a reviewer checklist.

Test	We believe	We're wrong if
H1·Need	Most families can't state their student's placement and next required course without help.	More than half of 8–10 families state both correctly.
H2·Cost	Each student takes at least 4 staff hours and 2 weeks today.	The median across 8–10 case managers is below either.
H3·Price	Affiliates will pay \$30 per student without a new grant.	Most budget holders can't name an approval path.

TARGETS

Time to a plan	2 wks → 3 days
Staff time per student	4 h → 2 h
Families who understand it	80%+
Plans districts accept	70%+

Early signal for H2: one transcript took 5+ hours across three weeks. Targets are hypotheses, not results.

THE TEAM

WHO'S BUILDING PASO.



HaYoung Kong

 [in/hayoungkong](https://www.linkedin.com/in/hayoungkong)



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Benjamin Karp

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THE ASK

WE'RE RAISING \$250K.

Pre-seed, on a post-money SAFE, to reach 1,000 signed plans in 18 months.

USE OF FUNDS



- **45%** Product: web app v1
- **30%** Pilots and bilingual reviewers
- **15%** Validation, privacy, compliance
- **10%** Go-to-market

IN 18 MONTHS

- 1,000** signed plans
- 10** paying affiliates
- 70%+** of plans accepted by districts
- 2** district pilots signed

How you can help:

Resettlement affiliate directors

District multilingual-ed leads

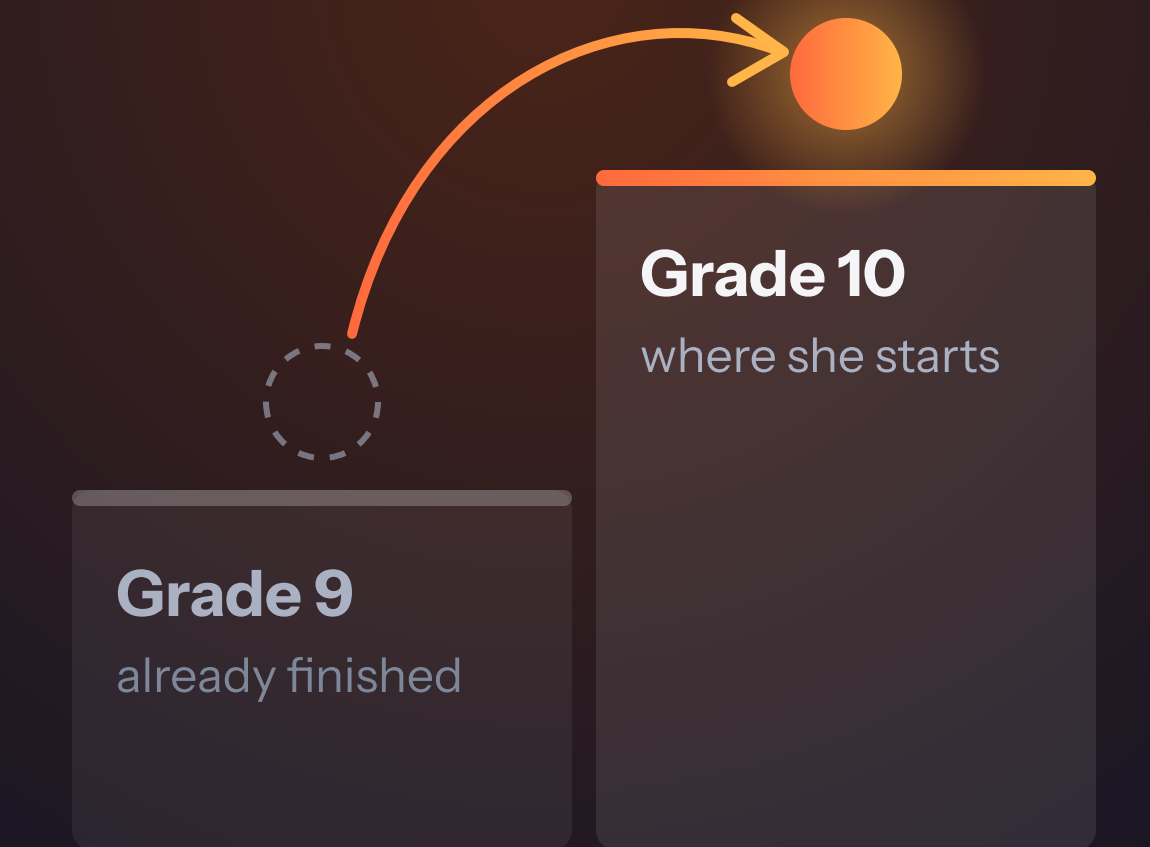
Spanish and Arabic reviewers

BACK TO ANA

ANA STARTS IN TENTH GRADE.

With Paso, her 4.5 credits count, her family reads the plan in Spanish, and she doesn't repeat a year she already finished.

Every step counts.



APPENDIX

SOURCES AND ASSUMPTIONS

Mantil et al. (2023), Rising Numbers, Unmet Needs, Annenberg Institute at Brown: arrivals at 16+, 54% graduation, 1 in 6.

Mantil et al. (2026), Land of Opportunity?, Annenberg Institute at Brown: 64% vs. 16% in 9th grade; 38-point adjusted gap.

U.S. Dept. of Education (OELA), Title III Biennial Report, SY 2020–22: 1,070,113 immigrant students (2021–22).

UNHCR, Global Trends 2025: about 45M forcibly displaced children, end of 2025.

U.S. Dept. of State, FY2025 refugee admissions report: 355 local resettlement sites.

Pew Research Center (2026): 10,258 refugees admitted in FY2026's first 10 months. Williams Institute: 100,034 in FY2024.

Prices: WES Course-by-Course from \$186; ECE Course by Course \$199 (company websites, Oct 2026).

Our research: Mom Test interview with a youth education specialist at a resettlement affiliate; competitive scan, Oct 2026.

Assumptions: \$120 district price; SAM = half of TAM; 10% of affiliates; 200 students per affiliate, 500 per district; reviewer 20 min at \$30/h; AI ≈ \$1 per plan.

Notes: Ana is a composite. Screens are prototypes with sample data. Targets and margins are hypotheses, not results. Standard codes such as A-REI.B.3 follow the Common Core numbering used in Massachusetts' math framework.